TaskFlow

Plan • Organize • Achieve

User Stories & Use Cases

Personal & Collaborative Project Management Platform

PROGRAM	**DEPI**
DOCUMENT	**User Stories & Use Cases**
VERSION	**1.0**
PREPARED	**14 October 2026**
STATUS	**Proposed requirements for team and instructor review**
AI	**Out of scope**

Scope note: TaskFlow supports individuals, freelancers, small teams, and companies. A user can start with a private workspace and enable team or client collaboration when needed. Public marketing pages are handled separately by Mostafa and are not included in these authenticated-app user stories. Stories and acceptance criteria below describe intended behavior; they should be finalized against the approved requirements and available implementation time.

1. Purpose

This document describes how different users are expected to interact with TaskFlow. It contains user stories, acceptance criteria, and detailed use cases that can guide implementation and testing. Each story should be linked to a GitHub Issue or development task when work is scheduled.

2. Actors

Actor	Description	Typical permissions / needs
Individual User	Uses TaskFlow independently for personal, academic, or professional projects.	Creates personal workspaces, projects, tasks, schedules, and time entries. Does not need to invite anyone.
Freelancer	Manages projects for one or more clients.	Tracks time, manages deliverables, and selectively shares approved project information with each client.
Team Member	Collaborates on projects in a shared workspace.	Views permitted tasks, updates assigned work, comments, adds attachments, tracks time, and hands over work.
Project Manager / Team Lead	Coordinates projects and team work.	Creates and configures projects, assigns tasks, monitors progress, manages project risks, and reviews delivery workflows.
Workspace Owner / Admin	Manages a workspace and its membership.	Invites or removes members, assigns roles, configures workspace settings, and controls access.
Client	External person invited to a specific project.	Views only shared project information, reviews shared deliverables, comments, approves a version, or requests changes.
Platform Administrator	Optional operator responsible for the TaskFlow installation.	Handles platform-level settings and operational support; not required for ordinary personal use.

3. User Stories and Acceptance Criteria

Priority definitions: **Must** = essential to the agreed first release; **Should** = important if time permits; **Could** = optional enhancement. Priority is a planning proposal and should be confirmed by the team and instructor.

Epic A — Account and Personal Workspace

US-01 — Register and sign in

Priority: Must
Story: As a user, I want to create an account and sign in securely so that I can access my projects and personal data.

Acceptance criteria:

- A user can register with the required account details and a valid password.
- Invalid or duplicate registration data produces clear validation messages.
- A registered user can sign in and sign out.
- Password recovery is available if enabled in the approved release.
- Protected pages require authentication.

US-02 — Start using TaskFlow independently

Priority: Must
Story: As an individual user, I want a private workspace by default so that I can organize work without creating a team or inviting other people.

Acceptance criteria:

- After onboarding, the user can access a personal workspace or create one with minimal setup.
- The user can create a project without inviting team members.
- Personal projects are not visible to unrelated users.
- Team and client collaboration features are optional and do not block personal use.

US-03 — View a personal dashboard

Priority: Must
Story: As a user, I want a dashboard showing my current work so that I can identify what needs attention.

Acceptance criteria:

- The dashboard displays relevant authorized projects and task summaries.
- Tasks due soon and overdue tasks can be identified.
- Empty states explain how to create the first project or task.
- Displayed counts and progress values match the defined calculation rules.

US-04 — Capture and find work quickly

Priority: Should
Story: As a user, I want to create a task quickly and search or save useful filters so that I can manage work without navigating through many screens.

Acceptance criteria:

- The user can create a task from the agreed quick-capture interface.

- Search results include only projects and records the user is authorized to access.
- The user can filter tasks by supported fields such as status, priority, assignee, due date, or label.
- If saved views are included, a user can save and reopen a personal filter.

Epic B — Workspace and Project Management

US-05 — Create and configure a project

Priority: Must

Story: As a user or project manager, I want to create and configure a project so that related tasks and activity stay organized in one place.

Acceptance criteria:

- An authorized user can provide a project name and required details.
- A project belongs to the correct personal or shared workspace.
- An authorized user can update project settings.
- A project can be archived according to the agreed rules; restoration is available if included in scope.

US-06 — Invite team members and assign access

Priority: Must for shared workspaces

Story: As a workspace owner, I want to invite members and assign roles so that people can collaborate with the correct permissions.

Acceptance criteria:

- An authorized owner/admin can invite a member through the agreed invitation flow.
- Membership and role changes are saved and enforced by the backend.
- Unauthorized users cannot view or modify workspace/project data by guessing a URL or identifier.
- A personal-only user can skip this workflow entirely.

Epic C — Task Management and Collaboration

US-07 — Create and manage tasks

Priority: Must

Story: As a project participant, I want to create and update tasks with details and deadlines so that work is clearly defined.

Acceptance criteria:

- Authorized users can create and edit task title, description, priority, due date, labels, and other approved fields.
- A task can be assigned according to project permissions.
- The system validates required fields and invalid dates or values.
- Task changes persist and can be seen by users who have permission.

US-08 — Manage work on a Kanban board

Priority: Must

Story: As a team member, I want to move tasks between workflow columns so that I can show their current status.

Acceptance criteria:

- The board displays tasks in their current columns.

- An authorized user can move a task to an allowed column using drag-and-drop or an accessible alternative.
- The new status and ordering persist after refresh.
- Configured workflow and WIP rules are enforced if enabled.
- Invalid or unauthorized transitions are rejected with clear feedback.

US-09 — Break work into subtasks and checklists

Priority: Should
Story: As a task owner, I want to divide a task into smaller items so that I can track detailed progress.

Acceptance criteria:

- An authorized user can add, edit, and complete subtasks/checklist items.
- The interface shows completion status or progress based on a documented rule.
- Deleting or archiving a parent task follows the agreed relationship rules.

US-10 — Collaborate through comments and files

Priority: Must
Story: As a project participant, I want to discuss a task and attach relevant files so that context stays with the work.

Acceptance criteria:

- Authorized participants can add comments to a task.
- Supported attachments are checked for permitted file size/type and are stored securely.
- A user cannot download files they are not authorized to access.
- If mentions are included, the mentioned user receives the configured notification.
- Internal-only content is not exposed to clients unless explicitly shared.

US-11 — See task changes and recent activity

Priority: Should
Story: As a project participant, I want to see important task changes so that I can understand who changed what and when.

Acceptance criteria:

- Important actions are recorded with actor, action, target, and timestamp where appropriate.
- Authorized users can view relevant activity history.
- Users cannot modify or delete audit entries unless an explicitly authorized retention process allows it.

US-12 — Hand over a task

Priority: Should
Story: As a team member, I want to record work completed, outstanding issues, and next steps when handing over a task so that another person can continue efficiently.

Acceptance criteria:

- A handover note can be linked to a task.
- It can include completed work, remaining work, blockers, and next steps.
- The previous and new responsible members can be identified when applicable.
- The handover history remains available to authorized users.

Epic D — Scheduling and Time Tracking

US-13 — Plan work on a Gantt timeline or calendar

Priority: Must for basic scheduling; advanced calculations may be deferred
Story: As a project manager or individual user, I want to see task dates and dependencies on a timeline so that I can plan work and understand schedule relationships.

Acceptance criteria:

- Tasks with applicable dates can be displayed on a calendar or timeline.
- Supported task dependencies are displayed and validated.
- Invalid date ranges and dependency cycles are rejected if dependency support is enabled.
- Changes made through the timeline are saved and reflected in the task record.
- Advanced critical-path calculations are only treated as complete if implemented and tested.

US-14 — Track work time with a timer

Priority: Must
Story: As a user, I want to start, pause, resume, and stop a timer for a task so that I can record the time spent on work.

Acceptance criteria:

- A user can start a timer associated with an authorized task.
- The system follows the agreed rule for active timers (recommended initial rule: one active timer per user).
- Pause/resume/stop actions are saved by the backend and do not count paused intervals as work time.
- Refreshing or reopening the browser does not silently create duplicate sessions.
- Incomplete or corrected sessions follow a documented, auditable process.

US-15 — Review timesheets and compare estimates with actuals

Priority: Should
Story: As a user or project manager, I want to view recorded time by date, task, person, and project so that I can understand where effort was spent.

Acceptance criteria:

- Time entries can be filtered by the supported date range and project/task fields.
- Totals match the stored entries and the documented duration calculation.
- Estimated versus actual time is displayed where estimates exist.
- Client-visible time summaries are shown only when explicitly enabled and authorized.

Epic E — Client Portal and Deliverable Review

US-16 — Give a client controlled project access

Priority: Must if client portal is included in the approved release
Story: As a freelancer or project manager, I want to invite a client to selected project information so that the client can follow progress without seeing private team data.

Acceptance criteria:

- The client is linked only to explicitly shared project(s).

- The client can access only approved/shared information through both the interface and direct requests.
- Internal comments, private attachments, other clients' projects, and restricted time data remain inaccessible.
- Access can be changed or revoked by an authorized user.

US-17 — Follow progress in the Project Live Room

Priority: Should
Story: As a client, I want to view approved progress, milestones, updates, and shared files so that I can understand the state of my project.

Acceptance criteria:

- The room shows the progress formula or a clear explanation of how progress is calculated.
- Only project information marked as client-visible is shown.
- Shared milestones and deliverables link to their relevant details.
- The displayed status matches the persisted project data and does not claim a feature is complete without evidence.

US-18 — Review a deliverable

Priority: Must if client review is included in the approved release
Story: As a client, I want to review a specific deliverable version and approve it or request changes so that acceptance is recorded clearly.

Acceptance criteria:

- The team can submit a deliverable version for review.
- An authorized client can approve the version or request changes and add feedback.
- Each decision records the deliverable version, reviewer, decision, and timestamp.
- A new version does not overwrite the history of an earlier version.
- Task completion and client deliverable approval remain separate states.

US-19 — Submit and process a change request

Priority: Should
Story: As a client, I want to request a change to the agreed work so that the team can evaluate its impact before starting extra work.

Acceptance criteria:

- A change request records its description, requester, status, and relevant project.
- The team can record expected schedule/effort/cost impact where applicable.
- The request can be approved, rejected, deferred, or returned for clarification according to configured rules.
- A request does not automatically change the approved scope before an authorized decision.
- The decision and history remain accessible to authorized users.

Epic F — Notifications, Reporting, and Project Health

US-20 — Receive useful notifications

Priority: Must for in-app notifications; email options depend on scope
Story: As a user, I want to receive notifications about relevant assignments, comments, due dates, and review decisions so that I can respond on time.

Acceptance criteria:

- Notifications are sent to the intended authorized recipients for supported events.
- A user can distinguish read and unread notifications.
- Notification preferences are respected where configurable.
- Reconnects or repeated events do not create unintended duplicate notifications where deduplication is required.

US-21 — View project reports and health alerts

Priority: Should
Story: As a project manager, I want to review progress, overdue tasks, recorded time, and rule-based alerts so that I can address issues earlier.

Acceptance criteria:

- Reports use documented formulas and persisted records.
- Alert rules are explicit, testable conditions (for example, a critical task is overdue by a configured threshold).
- Alerts identify the condition that triggered them and link to the relevant project/task when authorized.
- Charts and percentages do not imply an unimplemented prediction or AI analysis.

4. Use Cases

Use-case priority follows the same Must/Should definitions as the stories. Preconditions and alternate flows should be adapted if the final requirements change.

UC-01 — Register and enter TaskFlow

Primary actor: Individual User
Goal: Create an account and start using TaskFlow privately.
Preconditions: The user is not signed in and the application is available.
Priority: Must

Main flow:

1. The user opens the registration page.
2. The user enters the required account information and submits the form.
3. The system validates the information and creates the account.
4. If email verification is enabled, the system prompts the user to verify the address.
5. The user signs in and completes the minimum onboarding steps.
6. The system provides access to a private workspace or prompts the user to create one.
7. The user reaches the personal dashboard.

Alternate / exception flows:

- If input is invalid or the email already exists, the system shows a clear error and does not create a duplicate account.
- If verification is required but incomplete, protected access remains limited until verification is completed.
- If onboarding is skipped, the system provides a clear way to complete it later.

Postconditions: The user has an authenticated account and can access only their authorized workspace data.

UC-02 — Create a project and its first task

Primary actor: Individual User or Project Manager
Goal: Organize a new piece of work.
Preconditions: The user is signed in and has permission to create projects in the target workspace.
Priority: Must

Main flow:

1. The user opens the project list and selects Create Project.
2. The user enters the project name and required details.
3. The system validates and saves the project.
4. The user opens the project and selects Create Task.
5. The user enters the task title, description, due date, priority, and optional assignee or label.
6. The system validates and saves the task in the default workflow column.
7. The project overview and Kanban board display the new project/task.

Alternate / exception flows:

- If required data is missing or invalid, the system identifies the fields to correct.
- If the user lacks permission, the system rejects the action and does not persist unauthorized data.
- If saving fails, the system reports the error without showing the unsaved task as successfully created.

Postconditions: A project and its first task are stored and visible to authorized users.

UC-03 — Move a task through the Kanban workflow

Primary actor: Team Member
Goal: Update the progress state of a task.
Preconditions: The user has access to the project and permission to update the task.
Priority: Must

Main flow:

1. The user opens the project's Kanban board.
2. The user locates the task and moves it to another permitted column.
3. The system validates the transition and any configured WIP rule.
4. The system saves the new status and ordering.
5. The board updates and authorized connected users receive the appropriate real-time event.
6. The system records the activity if the action is covered by the activity log.

Alternate / exception flows:

- An invalid status transition or exceeded WIP limit is rejected or handled according to the configured policy.
- If the server save fails, the UI restores the previous persisted state or prompts the user to reload.
- An unauthorized user cannot perform the move even by sending a direct request.

Postconditions: The task's status and order reflect the saved result.

UC-04 — Record working time on a task

Primary actor: Individual User, Freelancer, or Team Member
Goal: Save accurate work time against a task.
Preconditions: The user is authenticated and can access the selected task.
Priority: Must

Main flow:

1. The user opens a task and selects Start Timer.
2. The system verifies that the task is accessible and checks the active-timer rule.
3. The server stores the session start time and active status.
4. The user may pause and later resume the session; each state change is saved.
5. The user selects Stop.
6. The system calculates the work duration according to the defined pause rules and saves the completed entry.
7. The updated total appears in the time-entry list or project report.

Alternate / exception flows:

- If another timer is already active and only one is allowed, the system explains that the current timer must be stopped or paused first.
- If the browser refreshes or reconnects, the UI retrieves the saved session state from the server.
- If a session is incomplete or its time is disputed, the system follows the documented correction process rather than silently altering the entry.

Postconditions: A time entry is saved once and associated with the correct user and task.

UC-05 — Invite a member to a workspace

Primary actor: Workspace Owner or Admin
Goal: Add a collaborator with the correct access.
Preconditions: The actor has workspace-management permission.
Priority: Must for shared workspaces

Main flow:

1. The owner opens Members and Invitations.
2. The owner enters the invitee's email address and selects the permitted role.
3. The system validates the request and creates an invitation.
4. The invitee follows the invitation flow and signs in or registers.
5. The system verifies the invitation and adds the member to the workspace.
6. The member can access only the workspace/projects allowed by the assigned role.

Alternate / exception flows:

- Duplicate, expired, or revoked invitations are rejected or handled by the defined resend process.
- A user without permission cannot invite members or elevate another user's role.
- Invitation delivery failure is reported and can be retried by an authorized user.

Postconditions: Membership and role are saved and enforced by server-side authorization.

UC-06 — Share a project with a client

Primary actor: Freelancer or Project Manager
Supporting actor: Client
Goal: Let a client follow only the intended project information.
Preconditions: The project exists and the actor can manage client access.
Priority: Must if Client Portal is included

Main flow:

1. The freelancer/manager opens the project's client-access settings.
2. The actor selects or invites a client and assigns access to the specific project.
3. The actor marks approved progress information, files, discussions, or deliverables as client-visible according to the sharing model.
4. The system saves the access configuration and sends an invitation/notification if configured.
5. The client opens the portal and signs in.
6. The system displays the shared project information only.

Alternate / exception flows:

- If the client opens an unrelated project URL or guesses a resource identifier, access is denied server-side.
- If the actor revokes access, subsequent requests are denied.
- Internal notes or private files remain hidden unless explicitly and validly shared.

Postconditions: The client can access only authorized, shared project information.

UC-07 — Submit and review a deliverable

Primary actor: Team Member or Project Manager
Supporting actor: Client
Goal: Share a work result and record the client's decision.
Preconditions: A project is shared with the client and the actor may submit deliverables.
Priority: Must if client review is included

Main flow:

1. The team member creates a deliverable record and uploads a file or adds an approved preview link.
2. The system stores the deliverable and version information.
3. An authorized team member submits the version for client review.
4. The client opens the version and reads the available details.
5. The client chooses Approve or Request Changes and may add feedback.
6. The system records the specific version, reviewer, decision, timestamp, and feedback.
7. The internal team sees the new review state and continues work according to the decision.

Alternate / exception flows:

- If the client requests changes, the deliverable becomes a revision-needed state and the feedback remains linked to that version.
- If a newer version is uploaded, the earlier version and its review history are retained.
- If the reviewer lacks permission, the decision is rejected.

Postconditions: The review decision is auditable and linked to the correct deliverable version.

UC-08 — Process a change request

Primary actor: Client
Supporting actors: Freelancer / Project Manager, Team Member
Goal: Evaluate a requested change before committing to extra work.
Preconditions: The client has access to the project and can submit requests.
Priority: Should

Main flow:

1. The client selects Request Change from the project live room or relevant deliverable.
2. The client describes the requested change and submits it.
3. The system records the request with a pending status.
4. The project manager reviews it and enters expected effort, schedule, and cost impact where relevant.
5. The authorized decision-maker approves, rejects, defers, or requests clarification.
6. The system records the decision and notifies the relevant parties.
7. Only after approval does the team update the agreed plan/backlog according to the change-control process.

Alternate / exception flows:

- A request may be returned for clarification or deferred without changing the approved scope.
- If rejected, the reason is recorded and the existing plan remains unchanged.
- Users who lack approval permission cannot approve the request.

Postconditions: The request and its decision history are preserved; approved changes are reflected in the plan as agreed.

UC-09 — Create and review a task handover

Primary actor: Current Task Owner
Supporting actor: Next Task Owner
Goal: Transfer task context so another person can continue the work.
Preconditions: The task exists and the current actor has permission to edit it.
Priority: Should

Main flow:

1. The current owner opens the task and chooses Add Handover Note.
2. The owner records completed work, remaining work, blockers, and next steps.
3. The owner identifies the next owner where applicable.
4. The system saves the handover record and its author/time.
5. The next owner opens the task and reads the handover note.
6. The next owner continues work and updates the task as appropriate.

Alternate / exception flows:

- If no next owner is known, the note can remain unassigned and visible to authorized project members.
- If the user lacks permission, the handover cannot be created or edited.

Postconditions: The task contains a durable handover record accessible to authorized users.

UC-10 — Respond to a project-health alert

Primary actor: Project Manager or authorized project member
Goal: Identify and respond to a defined project issue.
Preconditions: The project has a configured rule and the triggering data exists.
Priority: Should

Main flow:

1. A defined condition is met, such as a critical task passing its due date.
2. The system evaluates the configured rule and creates an alert.
3. An authorized recipient sees the alert in the dashboard/notification center.
4. The recipient opens the alert and views the reason and linked task/project.
5. The recipient takes corrective action or records a resolution note, if supported.
6. The system updates the alert state according to the agreed resolution rules.

Alternate / exception flows:

- If the rule condition is not met, no alert is generated.
- If the underlying task is no longer overdue, the alert is updated or resolved according to the documented rule.
- An unauthorized user cannot view restricted project details through the alert link.

Postconditions: The alert outcome and the related project data can be reviewed by authorized users.

5. Cross-Cutting Business Rules

1. **Server-side authorization:** Every read or change must be checked on the server. Hiding controls in the UI is not sufficient.
2. **Personal-first usage:** A user must be able to use core projects and tasks without creating a team or inviting a client.
3. **Client isolation:** A client can access only explicitly shared projects and information. Internal comments and private attachments are not client-visible by default.
4. **Task completion vs. delivery approval:** A task can be technically complete while a deliverable still awaits client review. These states must not be treated as identical.
5. **Time integrity:** Time calculations follow documented start/pause/resume/stop rules, and corrections must be traceable.
6. **Change approval:** A requested scope change does not alter the agreed plan until an authorized decision is recorded.
7. **Progress calculations:** The system must document how progress is calculated and apply the same rule consistently across dashboards and client views.
8. **No AI:** Search, automation, alerts, progress calculations, and reports use ordinary deterministic logic and recorded data; no AI-generated outputs are in scope.

6. Traceability to Team Ownership

User story / use-case area	Primary owner	Collaborators
Account, onboarding, personal dashboard, My Work, quick capture, search, notifications	Mostafa Mohamed Mahmoud Mohamed	All modules provide agreed contracts/events
Workspaces, teams, members, invitations, roles, projects	Ahmed Reda Ahmed Sedik	Mostafa for Identity conventions; Eman for client-project access
Tasks, Kanban, subtasks, comments, attachments, task activity, handover	Alaa Essam Hamed Abdelkader	Ahmed for project references; Ahd for timer/dependency links; Eman for deliverable links
Timer, time entries, timesheets, Gantt, calendar, reports, project-health alerts	Ahd Ammar Eisa El-Baqary	Alaa for task data; Eman for deliverable-review state where relevant
Client portal, Project Live Room, deliverables, reviews, change requests	Eman Mohamed Masad El-Metwally	Ahmed for project access; Alaa for tasks/attachments; Ahd for approved time summaries

7. Review and Approval

The stories and use cases should be reviewed with the team and DEPI instructor. The team should assign each agreed story a GitHub Issue, refine acceptance criteria, and mark its scope as Must, Should, or Could before implementation.

Reviewer	Name	Status / Date
Team Lead	Mostafa Mohamed Mahmoud Mohamed	Pending team review
Team Representative	To be confirmed	Pending
DEPI Instructor / Reviewer	To be confirmed	Pending

8. Notes and Limitations

- These user stories and use cases describe proposed product behavior; they are not evidence that the features have already been implemented or tested.
- The implementation schedule may require deferring Should/Could features. Any deferral must be recorded in the project plan and GitHub backlog.
- The original TaskFlow proposal includes Kanban, Gantt, task management, real-time collaboration, comments, attachments, reports, notifications, activity logging, automation, and deployment. Added client/time workflows are included here because they were selected during project planning; final scope should be confirmed by the team and instructor.